

UTEP may hire Wing as baseball coach

Special to the Citizen

EL PASO — Andy Cohen, the colorful baseball coach of the University of Texas-El Paso, has officially retired and the leading candidate for replacing him appears to be Jim Wing, assistant coach at the University of Arizona.

Cohen, a remarkably active 73-year-old, played major league baseball for John McGraw of the old New York Giants in the 1920s. His brother, Sid, 74, who helps coach UTEP, played in the old Washington Senator organization.

Cohen has coached the Miners since the school began

playing intercollegiate baseball in 1963. His 16-year record is 300-353-2.

Cohen's best season was 1967 when the Miners were 25-12-1 as an independent.

Wing, who is in his sixth year as an assistant to UA head coach Jerry Kindall, was interviewed for the Texas-El Paso job when Arizona played in El Paso April 28-29.

UTEP athletic director Jim Bowden indicated Wing was a strong candidate for the job. Wing is the pitching and catching coach at UA.

Wing was head coach at Tucson's Palo Verde High School for eight years. He also was junior varsity coach at Tucson High for five years. He was the 1965 Tucson Coach of the Year.

Wing earned a freshman letter at Arizona in 1955, but an injury prevented him from continuing his career. He received both a BS and master's degree from UA.

Texas-El Paso officials said applicants will be screened for the next two weeks, in compliance with federal regulations, and a successor to Cohen won't be announced until after that time.